

The Map

Thirteen chapters, three movements, one brain.

◆ MOVEMENT I — UNDERSTANDING THE BRAIN

01 What is AuDHD?

ADHD says yes; autism says no — one brain, two opposing magnets.

02 Childhood

Behaviour that looks like defiance is usually a nervous system in survival mode.

03 Adolescence

Puberty intensifies everything; safe adults and open talk are the protection.

04 Learning

His real intelligence often lives exactly where school doesn't look.

◆ MOVEMENT II — THE HIDDEN COST

05 Vulnerability

The same wiring that makes him remarkable can leave him open to harm.

06 Mental Health

A crisis is a signal to change something — not a flaw.

07 Trauma

Don't let his reality be overwritten; rebuild trust in tiny steps.

08 Support

Support makes the world fit him — the aim is never to 'fix' him.

◆ MOVEMENT III — BLOOMING DIFFERENTLY

09 Employment

The right environment turns 'can't' into thriving.

10 Transitions

Even good change is a threat; preview, predict, and build a runway.

11 Paradoxes

Notice which engine drives today; guard against the pull to isolate.

12 Diagnosis

A diagnosis is a tool, not a verdict; reactions are about them.

13 Acceptance

There's no fix because nothing is broken — and he gets to grow up understood.

"Not quite a horse, not quite a zebra — imagine a unicorn."

Leanne Maskell

The Action Card

Pin it where you'll see it.

SEE

see the world he sees

- ◆ **Read the world bottom-up**
Give him a beat before you expect an answer.
- ◆ **Know the two engines**
Name whether ADHD or autism is driving right now.
- ◆ **Sensory needs are needs**
The label, the noise, the texture — all real.
- ◆ **'Naughty' means overwhelmed**
Meltdown is the fight response; shutdown is freeze.
- ◆ **Mind the deep dive**
Warn him before pulling him out of focus.
- ◆ **He can't always name the feeling**
Help him find the words for it.
- ◆ **Same wiring, real strengths**
Detail, depth, honesty, resilience.

STEADY

build what he needs

- ◆ **Lower the demand, offer a choice**
'Before or after the bath?'
- ◆ **Make transitions visible**
Preview it. Pack ahead. Clock in sight.
- ◆ **Explain the why**
'Because I said so' is the one thing he can't use.
- ◆ **Build a calm-down kit together**
Make it genuinely his.
- ◆ **Protect the after-school crash**
Wind-down time, no stacked demands.
- ◆ **Work with school as a team**
Request what helps; keep him in the loop.
- ◆ **Make asking for help safe**
'You'll never be in trouble for it.'

CHAMPION

protect who he is

- ◆ **Child first, label second**
AuDHD isn't a verdict.
- ◆ **Tell him the truth about his wiring**
The information empowers him.
- ◆ **Use your own ADHD as a bridge**
You know half of this from the inside.
- ◆ **Catch and name the strengths**
Out loud, and often.
- ◆ **Check in; listen before fixing**
If you're worried, ask directly.
- ◆ **Get your own support**
What you put in, he gets back.
- ◆ **Just more rainbow**
He gets to grow up understood.